



Privacy Policy

EFFECTIVE 01 JULY 2026

VERSION 1.0

WARNING!

Information contained in this document is intended
for flight simulation purposes only.

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Purpose of Document

This document establishes the official Privacy Policy for VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa (VATSSA). It sets out how VATSSA collects, uses, stores, protects and processes personal data in connection with any divisional activities, systems or services within VATSSA. VATSSA staff reserve the right to take action where personal data is misused or where this policy is breached. This policy has been developed to achieve the following objectives:

- To establish clear standards for the collection, handling, protection, and appropriate use of personal data within VATSSA systems and activities.
- To define the rights, responsibilities, and expectations of users in relation to VATSSA's processing of personal data.
- To ensure compliance with applicable data protection legislation, including the EU GDPR, and alignment with VATSIM's Data Protection and Handling Policy.
- To ensure that personal data is processed lawfully, fairly, securely, and transparently in all VATSSA operations.
- To outline how and why personal data is collected and used within VATSSA systems and services.

VATSSA is committed to delivering a professional, supportive, and safe environment for all, regardless of their home division. As such, this policy applies to all individuals whose personal data is processed by VATSSA in connection with divisional activities, operations, or engagement through VATSSA platforms and systems.

1. Control Pages

1.1. Document Identification

Type	Policy
Revision	06/2026
Issue Date	
Effective Date	
Prepared By	Wian Saptouw - VATSSA1 & Josh Martin - VATSSA3
Approved By	Wian Saptouw – VATSSA1 (Division Director)
Next Review Due	1st January 2027
Identification	VATSSA_POL_PRIVACY_06-2026.pdf

1.2. Revision Records

Version	Date	Description	Author
1.0	06/2026	Initial Policy Drafted	

2. General Provisions

2.1. Applicability

This policy applies to all members and visitors of the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa division whose personal data is processed by VATSSA, regardless of their home region. It also applies to any individuals whose personal data is processed in connection with interaction with VATSSA systems, services, or activities. Members are responsible for familiarising themselves with the contents of this policy, as well as any relevant VATSIM policies. VATSSA's Data Protection Officer holds full discretion to waive or amend aspects of this policy as necessary for VATSSA's benefit.

The content of this document reflects the essential modifications and regulations concerning EU GDPR and VATSIM's Data Protection and Handling Policy.

2.2. Non-Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy, particularly in relation to the improper handling, access or processing of personal data, may result in immediate referral to the VATSIM Membership Department and, where applicable, the VATSIM Board of Governors.

2.3. Changes

This policy is subject to periodic review and amendment. Amendments may be made by the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa Data Protection Officer as required to address its clarity and effectiveness. Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, which will be published at vatssa.com.

VATSSA does not knowingly process or collect data from children under the age of 13.

If it is believed that VATSSA has inadvertently collected or processed personal data belonging or relating to a child under the age of 13, the Data Protection Officer should be contacted without delay so that appropriate action can be taken, including the review and, where necessary, the erasure of data.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Staff Member	Any member of the VATSIM Sub-Sahara Africa staff team.
Member	An account holder / user is considered a member of the VATSIM community.
Personal Data	Any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person, e.g., name, email address, age.
Data Protection Officer	The person responsible for ensuring the management, organisation and processing of data within VATSSA is EU GDPR compliant.
Consent	A freely given, specific, informed and unambiguous indication of a data subject's wishes by which they, by a statement or by a clear affirmative action, signifies agreement to the processing of personal data relating to themselves.
Legitimate Interest	The processing is needed for your legitimate interest or the interests of a third party.

4. Personal data we collect

VATSSA collects data from you under the lawful basis of legitimate interests. We collect this data for operational purposes. We obtain this data through the VATSIM API and your interactions with our infrastructure. The data we collect includes:

- Your full name,
- Your VATSIM CID,
- Your VATSIM registered email address,
- Your region, division and subdivision,
- Your simulated Air Traffic Control and/or pilot rating they have obtained via training with the VATSIM network

You have choices when it comes to data use and the data you share. Our infrastructure requires some personal data to provide you with a service. If you choose not to provide data required to provide you with a product or service, you cannot use that product or service. We will notify you if this is the case. Where providing the data is optional, and you choose not to share personal data, services such as personalisation that use such data will not work for you.

5. How we use personal data

VATSSA uses the data we collect to provide you with enjoyable experiences. In particular, we use data to:

- Provide ATC training,
- Provide support.
- Improve and develop our infrastructure.

We also use the data for other operational purposes, which includes maintaining infrastructure.

VATSSA does not knowingly process data through the use of artificial intelligence systems.

VATSSA does not knowingly collect data that may be reasonably construed to form a profile.

If it is believed that VATSSA has inadvertently collected profiles or processed personal data using artificial intelligence systems, the data protection officer should be contacted so that appropriate action can be taken, including the review and, where necessary, the erasure of data.

6. Reasons we share personal data

We share your personal data with your consent with VATSIM for operational benefits.

7. Retention of Your Personal Data

VATSSA will retain your personal data only for as long as is necessary for the purposes set out in this Privacy Policy. We will retain and use your personal data to the extent necessary to provide our services.

VATSSA does not have a defined retention period due to the possibility of ongoing training and/or access to our infrastructure.

We securely delete or anonymise personal data according to the following procedures:

- Deletion: Personal data is removed from our systems and no longer actively processed.
- Backup retention: Residual copies may remain in encrypted backups for a limited period.
- Anonymisation: In some cases, we convert personal data into anonymous statistical data that cannot be linked back to you.

8. Data Security

The security of your data is important to us; however, no method of transmission over the Internet or method of electronic storage is 100% secure. While we strive to use commercially acceptable means to protect your personal information, we cannot guarantee its absolute security.

9. Data Subject Rights

The EU GDPR provides data subjects specific rights relating to the collection, processing, storage and disclosure of their personal data. VATSSA shall take reasonable steps to ensure that these rights are respected and that requests relating to them are handled in accordance with EU GDPR and VATSIM policy. Data subject rights include:

- Right to be Informed
- Right of Access
- Right to Rectification
- Right to Erasure
- Right to Restrict Processing
- Right to Object to Processing
- Right to Data Portability
- Rights to Automated Decision Making and Profiling

VATSSA has published further information regarding the internal processes for compiling these requests through our Data Protection and Handling Policy, which can be found at vatssa.com.

Members wishing to withdraw consent should exercise their rights listed above.

10. Complaints

VATSSA shall make every effort to ensure compliance with EU GDPR, VATSIM's Data Protection and Handling policy, and VATSSA's Data Protection and Handling policy.

Should you feel VATSSA has failed to comply with any of the above policies, you may contact the VATSIM Membership Department via support.vatsim.net.

11. Contact Details

Contact	Contact Details
VATSSA1	vatssa1@vatssa.com
Data Protection Officer	dpo@vatssa.com
VATSSA Membership Department	membership@vatssa.com
VATSSA Tech Department	tech@vatssa.com

12. Enforcement

12.1 Disciplinary Action

VATSSA has a zero-tolerance policy towards the inappropriate use of data and failure to comply with this policy will result in sanctions being imposed and referral to the VATSIM Membership Department. Sanctions are at the discretion of VATSSA1.

VATSSA reserves the right to restrict or revoke access to divisional services and infrastructure, including training services and communication platforms, in accordance with this policy and other applicable divisional procedures.

13. Authority

- This policy is enforced by the VATSSA data protection officer and authorised by the Division Director.
- Decisions made under this policy are final unless otherwise stated by VATSSA procedures.

14. Review and Amendments

- This policy is subject to biannual review to ensure continued relevance and effectiveness, or when otherwise requested by the Division Director.
- Amendments to this policy may be made by the VATSSA Data Protection Officer as required.
- Members will be expected to comply with the most current published version of this policy, published at <https://vatssa.com>.